

electricity, not get it free
AAP/ Congress: Free 300 units

↘ Jobs
BJP: 2 million jobs in five years, women to get 100,000 government jobs
AAP/ Congress: 1 million new government jobs. Congress, additionally, promises 500,000 government jobs plus 33 per cent reservation for women

↘ Unemployment benefits
BJP: Silent
AAP/ Congress: Rs 3,000 monthly dole to youth. AAP promises additional Rs 1,000 allowance to women above 18

↘ Other freebies
BJP: Free electric scooters to meritorious college-going female students from financially weak households, free bus travel to female senior citizens, free bicycles to all female students from Class 9 to 12
Congress: Free laptop for MBA, engineering and medical students

↘ Urban infrastructure
BJP: Saurashtra Express Highway Grid to be developed. Seamless connectivity between important economic hubs. Decongesting cities with satellite townships, increasing ease of living with riverfronts, recreational parks, urban forests, traffic management systems. Metro service in Gandhinagar, Surat, Rajkot, Vadodara
Congress: Metro in Surat, Rajkot, Vadodara

↘ Religion
BJP: Devbhumi Dwarka Corridor to be established as western India's biggest spiritual centre, the world's tallest Krishna statue
Congress: Direct bus connectivity to places of pilgrimage
AAP: Free visit to Ayodhya

↘ Farmers' loans
BJP: Silent
Congress: Waive farmer loans up to Rs 3 lakh
AAP: Waive farmers' outstanding loans up to Rs 2 lakh

UTTAR PRADESH

FALL OF A 'VICE' CHANCELLOR



POWER, CUT
V-C Vinay Kumar Pathak

By Prashant Srivastava

It's unusual for universities to be considered playgrounds of the power elite, but one vice-chancellor in Uttar Pradesh had managed to do exactly that in the past decade and a half. Vinay Kumar Pathak, 53, the V-C of the Chhatrapati Shahu Ji Maharaj University in Kanpur, whose misdeeds are now under the scanner of the UP police, held the chair in different universities for almost 13 years.

The man himself has gone AWOL but the FIR against him lists a number of charges, including bribery, corruption, illegal confinement and extortion. Apart from this, there is a pending investigation from back in 2018 on charges levelled by a University Grants Commission (UGC) member referring to "plagiarism and misrepresentation of facts" in his CV. One of the charges is that his profile claimed he had been elevated as a professor in January 2006 at the Harcourt Butler Technical Institute in Kanpur, while in reality the promotion came a year later, in January 2007. On November 12, the Allahabad High Court rejected a petition filed by him to quash the FIR. The STF (special task force) investigating the case has got a lookout notice out for the V-C.

Pathak, though controversial, has had stints as V-C of several UP universities

On October 29, David Denis, man-